

A PRACTICAL CHECKLIST · FOR INDEPENDENT AGENCIES

AI Without the **Hype**. A practical checklist for independent insurance agencies.

Evaluate your AI readiness and find your best starting point.

This checklist covers the areas where most agencies leave time and opportunity on the table. Work through each section, check the boxes that apply, and use the scoring guide at the end to identify your next step.

HOW TO USE THIS CHECKLIST

- 1 Work through each section.**
Three in total: Awareness, Readiness, and Starting Points.
- 2 Check the box if your agency has it in place.** Leave it unchecked if it isn't done — or you're unsure.
- 3 Use the scoring guide at the end.**
Your unchecked items show where to focus next.

SECTION 01

AI Awareness

Establish your baseline.

What do you actually know about AI in your agency right now? This section establishes your baseline before any tool evaluation or implementation planning begins.

- | | | |
|--------------------------|---|----|
| ☐ | Current AI usage
I can name at least one specific AI tool or workflow my agency is currently using — not just general tools used occasionally. | 01 |
| ☐ | Insurance vs. general AI
I understand the difference between tools built for insurance agencies and general-purpose AI. Insurance-specific tools integrate with your AMS. General-purpose tools do not. | 02 |
| ☐ | AMS platform knowledge
I know which AMS my agency runs and whether it supports AI or workflow automation. Applied, HawkSoft, EZLynx, and Vertafore all support some level of automation. | 03 |
| ☐ | Shadow AI awareness
My staff is not using AI tools I'm unaware of to handle client data. Shadow AI adoption is a compliance and security risk. If you're unsure, leave this unchecked. | 04 |
| ☐ | Staff input gathered
I have asked my staff what repetitive tasks they wish were automated. This is the most important conversation most agency owners have not had yet. | 05 |
| ☐ | Success defined
I can describe what a successful AI implementation looks like for my agency in specific terms: hours saved, documents produced, tasks eliminated. | 06 |

▶ SECTION 1 SCORING GUIDE — COUNT UNCHECKED ITEMS

1 0–1 unchecked · Strong awareness
Move on to Section 2.

2 2–3 unchecked · Foundational gaps
Review the AI guide before evaluating tools.

3 4+ unchecked · Start with education
Get grounded, then return to this checklist.

Implementation Readiness

Are you set up to actually implement?

Readiness is the prerequisite. Buying a tool before your agency is ready to implement it creates more problems than it solves.

☐

Clean AMS data

01

My agency's data in the AMS is reasonably clean and consistently structured. AI tools are only as good as the data they connect to.

☐

Internal owner identified

02

I have at least one staff member who could own an AI implementation project. Doesn't need to be technical — just someone who will follow through.

☐

Budget range established

03

I have a budget range in mind, even if approximate. Most implementations cost between \$200 and \$2,000 per month depending on scope.

☐

Bandwidth available

04

My agency has bandwidth to spend 4 to 8 hours on implementation in the next 30 days. This is the realistic minimum for a first implementation.

☐

Testing period understood

05

I understand that AI implementation requires a testing period before full deployment. Tools that go live without testing create more problems than they solve.

☐

Error reporting process

06

I have a process for staff to report when an AI tool produces incorrect output. Human review is required for any AI output that affects a client or a policy.

▶ SECTION 2 SCORING GUIDE — COUNT UNCHECKED ITEMS

1

0–1 unchecked · Ready to implement

Move on to Section 3.

2

2–3 unchecked · Address gaps first

Focus on data quality and ownership before tool evaluation.

3

4+ unchecked · Don't buy a tool yet

Readiness is the prerequisite. Get this section mostly checked first.

High-Value Starting Points

Where automation will move the needle.

Which of these workflows is costing your agency the most staff hours right now? Check every item that applies — your checked items are where automation would have the highest immediate impact.

☐

Manual document production

01

My staff produces certificates of insurance, renewal letters, or policy summaries manually. Document generation automation is the highest-priority starting point for most agencies.

☐

Manual call logging

02

My agency manually logs call notes or activities into the AMS after phone calls. Call recording to AMS activity creation eliminates this entirely.

☐

Manual commission entry

03

My agency processes carrier commission statements manually each month. Automatic commission statement entry is one of the fastest ROI implementations available.

☐

Manual renewal follow-up

04

My staff spends time on renewal follow-up that could be automated. Renewal sequences configured in your AMS run without staff intervention once set up.

☐

Manual reporting

05

My agency generates regular reports that require pulling data from more than one system. AI reporting automation eliminates the aggregation step.

☐

Repetitive inbound

06

My agency has inbound calls or emails that follow predictable, repetitive patterns. Triage and routing automation handles this without replacing complex conversations.

☐

Missing SOPs

07

My agency does not have written SOPs for at least three of its most common workflows. SOP generators produce first drafts from recordings or transcripts in minutes.

SECTION 3 SCORING GUIDE — COUNT CHECKED ITEMS

1

1–2 checked · Start with the costliest

Pick the one that costs the most staff hours per week.

2

3–4 checked · Multiple starting points

Prioritize by staff hours saved and AMS connection.

3

5+ checked · Significant opportunity

Book a call to build a sequenced plan.

Count your unchecked items across **Sections 1 & 2**.

That's your readiness score. Find your band below — it tells you the single highest-leverage move to make next.

TOTAL UNCHECKED _____ /12 Sections 1 (Awareness) + 2 (Readiness)	TALLY YOUR SCORE _____ + _____ = _____ Section 1 unchecked + Section 2 unchecked = Total. Then circle the band that contains your number, below.	
0-3 UNCHECKED Strong Foundation You have the basics in place. Your next step is identifying the single highest-value workflow to automate and evaluating two to three tools specifically for that problem. Now look at what you checked in Section 3 — those are your starting points.	4-9 UNCHECKED Ready to Start You have some gaps but you're not starting from zero. Focus on Section 3 — your unchecked items there are your highest-priority starting points. Pick one and begin. Focus on Section 3. Your checked items are where to begin.	10+ UNCHECKED Build the Foundation Start with Section 2. Implementation readiness is the prerequisite for everything else. Get data clean, identify an internal owner, and confirm AMS capabilities first. Work through Section 2 first, then come back to Section 3.

▶ YOUR SECTION 3 RESULTS

What you checked in **Section 3** is where we start.

Every item you checked in Section 3 is a workflow Archway has automated for an independent insurance agency. We have built the call recording to AMS activity creation. We have built the commission statement automation. We have built the document generation workflows, the renewal sequences, and the SOP generators.

Sam Ruben leads AI implementation at Archway. He works exclusively with independent insurance agencies and has built these automations for agencies your size.

If you checked two or more items in Section 3, a 30-minute call with Sam is worth your time. He will look at what you checked, tell you which one delivers the fastest ROI for an agency like yours, and walk you through what implementation actually looks like.

Book 30 Minutes With Sam →

meetings-na2.hubspot.com/sam-ruben

No pitch. Just an honest look at where to start.

Built for independent agencies, by the team that **works inside them.**

For 30+ years Archway has been the operations and technology partner for independent insurance agencies — and now we build the AI automations that move the needle.

► WHY AGENCIES TRUST ARCHWAY

30+ yrs

SERVING AGENCIES

400+

INDEPENDENT AGENCIES

5,983+

DESKTOPS SECURED

\$200–\$2K

TYPICAL MONTHLY
SCOPE

MEET SAM RUBEN

Leads AI implementation at Archway.

Sam works exclusively with independent insurance agencies. He has built the call recording to AMS activity creation, the commission statement automation, document generation workflows, renewal sequences, and SOP generators referenced earlier in this checklist — for agencies the same size as yours.

When you book a call with Sam, you get an honest review of what you checked, which automation delivers the fastest ROI for an agency like yours, and a realistic picture of what implementation looks like.

WHAT WE BUILD

- **Call → AMS activity** — recordings turned into structured AMS notes automatically.
- **Commission statements** — carrier statements parsed and posted without manual entry.
- **Document generation** — certificates, renewal letters, policy summaries on demand.
- **Renewal sequences** — multi-touch follow-up that runs without staff intervention.
- **SOP generators** — first-draft SOPs from a recorded walkthrough.
- **Reporting & triage** — cross-system reporting and inbound routing.

READY WHEN YOU ARE

A 30-minute call. No pitch.

An honest look at where to start, based on what you checked.

Book 30 Minutes With Sam →